

HOW TO MAKE A SHOE BOX PLANT

This experiment is relatively easy for you—but hard work for the plant! You'll grow a bean from a seed and make a secret obstacle course for it to scramble through. There's some cutting out to do with scissors, but that's the only part you might need help with. You can't start the experiment until your seed produces a shoot. So first pot up your bean and put it on a windowsill for a few days. While you wait, you can build the shoe box maze. Once everything is in place, you'll have to try and be patient for a little longer.



Time

45 minutes plus
growing time



Difficulty

Medium

WHAT YOU NEED



Card stock



Potting soil in
a plastic cup



Masking tape



Fava bean
seeds



Water in a spray bottle



Paints



Paintbrush



Scissors



1 Push a fava bean seed into potting soil, to about 1 in (2.5 cm) below the surface.



2 Use the water sprayer to dampen the soil—this will make a seed grow in a few days. Make sure it gets sunlight.

The word
for the way
a plant grows
toward light is
phototropism.



Shoe box

